

Daily Bible Note

Date: August 14, 2026

I. Today's Reading

NKJV: Ezekiel 39:21–29

21 "I will set My glory among the nations; all the nations shall see My judgment which I have executed, and My hand which I have laid on them.

22 So the house of Israel shall know that I am the Lord their God from that day forward.

23 The Gentiles shall know that the house of Israel went into captivity for their iniquity; because they were unfaithful to Me, therefore I hid My face from them. I gave them into the hand of their enemies, and they all fell by the sword.

24 According to their uncleanness and according to their transgressions I have dealt with them, and hidden My face from them.'

25 "Therefore thus says the Lord God: 'Now I will bring back the captives of Jacob, and have mercy on the whole house of Israel; and I will be jealous for My holy name—

26 after they have borne their shame, and all their unfaithfulness in which they were unfaithful to Me, when they dwelt safely in their own land and no one made them afraid.

27 When I have brought them back from the peoples and gathered them out of their enemies' lands, and I am hallowed in them in the sight of many nations,

28 then they shall know that I am the Lord their God, who sent them into captivity among the nations, but also brought them back to their land, and left none of them captive any longer.

29 And I will not hide My face from them anymore; for I shall have poured out My Spirit on the house of Israel,' says the Lord God."

II. Key Summary

- God says He will set His glory among the nations so that all of them see the judgment He has carried out; from that day on, the house of Israel will know that the Lord is their God

(vv. 21–22).

- God gives the reason Israel went into captivity: they were unfaithful to Him, so He dealt with them according to their uncleanness and transgressions and hid His face from them, handing them over to their enemies (vv. 23–24).

- The Lord God declares that He will bring back the captives, have mercy on the whole house of Israel, be jealous for His holy name, and hide His face no more, because He has poured out His Spirit on the house of Israel (vv. 25–29).

III. Passage Analysis

Why God Hid His Face

The nations would know that Israel's suffering was never because God was unable to help them. The calamity came upon the house of Israel because of their sin and unfaithfulness. That was why Yahweh hid His face from them. [1]

The exile looked like God had lost, when in fact it was God Himself doing the disciplining. He spells out the reason so that nobody misreads who He is.

The Promise That He Will Not Hide Again

The indwelling of the Spirit is an infallible pledge of the continuance of God's favour. He will hide his face no more from those on whom he has poured out his Spirit. [2]

God's guarantee here isn't "try harder next time" — it's His own Spirit placed inside them. The passage ends by putting the weight of restoration on God, not on their performance.

IV. Reflection Question

When you've done something wrong and you feel awful about yourself, what do you think God's attitude toward you is right now?

In Ezekiel, God says He hid His face because of sin — and then promises, "I will not hide My face from them anymore," because He has poured out His Spirit.

References

[1] Enduring Word, David Guzik, Commentary on Ezekiel 39,
<https://enduringword.com/bible-commentary/ezekiel-39/>

[2] Blue Letter Bible, Matthew Henry's Commentary on Ezekiel 39,
https://www.blueletterbible.org/Comm/mhc/Eze/Eze_039.cfm